

Rental Invoicing App

Business Requirement Document

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Document Type	Business Requirement Document (BRD)

1. Purpose & Overview

This document outlines the business requirements for a Rental Invoicing Application designed for building owners and property managers. The application enables owners (landlords) to manage their properties, tenants, and rental rates, and to generate professional, customizable, GST-compliant monthly invoices as PDF documents. The system also supports multiple landlords operating under a single platform, distinguishes between GST-registered and non-GST landlords, and produces monthly GST reports to support statutory tax filing.

The application is intended to replace manual, spreadsheet-based rent invoicing with a structured, auditable, and scalable system that reduces administrative effort, minimizes calculation errors, and improves consistency in tenant billing.

2. Business Objectives

- **Centralize property & tenant data** — Maintain a single source of truth for properties, tenants, and landlords, replacing scattered spreadsheets and manual records.
- **Automate monthly invoicing** — Generate accurate, rate-based rental invoices every month with minimal manual intervention.
- **Ensure GST compliance** — Correctly apply GST only where the landlord is GST-registered, and produce accurate monthly GST collection reports.
- **Support multi-landlord operations** — Allow a single platform (e.g. operated by a property management company) to manage invoicing for multiple, independent landlords.
- **Enable branded, professional invoices** — Allow each landlord/property to have a customized invoice template with logo, colours, and business details.
- **Provide role-appropriate access** — Ensure Admins, Managers, and Landlords each see and do only what is relevant to their role.

3. Scope

3.1 In Scope

- Master data management for Properties, Landlords/Owners, and Tenants
- Rental rate configuration per property/tenant, including GST applicability
- Monthly invoice generation based on defined rates and billing period
- Customizable invoice templates (logo, colours, business name, layout)
- PDF generation and storage of invoices
- Support for multiple landlords, each flagged as GST-registered or Non-GST
- Monthly GST report generation for GST-registered landlords
- Role-based access control for Admin, Manager, and Landlord roles

3.2 Out of Scope (Phase 1)

- Online rent payment collection / payment gateway integration
- Tenant-facing self-service portal (tenants do not log into the system)
- Automated e-invoicing / IRN generation with GST Network (GSTN)
- Integration with accounting software (e.g. Tally, Zoho Books) — noted as a future enhancement
- Automated payment reminders / SMS / WhatsApp notifications — noted as a future enhancement

4. Stakeholders & User Roles

The system supports three primary user roles, each with a distinct scope of access:

- **Admin** — Owns and maintains all master data in the system — properties, landlords, tenants, rental rates, invoice templates, and user accounts. Has unrestricted access across all landlords and properties.
- **Manager** — Operates the day-to-day invoicing process. Can generate monthly invoices across properties/landlords assigned to them, and review invoices and GST reports for the landlords they manage. Cannot alter core master data such as landlord or template configuration.
- **Landlord** — A property owner using the system to track their own rental business. Can view and download their own invoices and their own monthly/GST reports only. Cannot view data belonging to other landlords, and cannot generate invoices.

4.1 Roles & Permissions Matrix

Feature / Module	Admin	Manager	Landlord
Manage Properties (Create/Edit)	Full	No	No
Manage Landlords / Owners	Full	No	No
Manage Tenants (PAN/GST details)	Full	Assigned Only	No
Define Rental Rates	Full	No	No
Manage Invoice Templates	Full	No	No
Generate Monthly Invoices	Full	Full	No
View Invoices	Full	Assigned Only	Own Only
Download Invoice PDF	Full	Full	Own Only
View GST Monthly Report	Full	Full	Own Only
Manage Users & Roles	Full	No	No
System Configuration	Full	No	No

5. Functional Requirements

5.1 Property Management

Admins can define and maintain a master list of properties, each linked to an owning landlord.

- Create, edit, and deactivate property records
- Capture property address, type (Residential/Commercial), and total area
- Link each property to its owning Landlord
- Mark property status as Active / Inactive (e.g. sold or under renovation)

5.2 Landlord / Owner Management

The system supports multiple landlords operating independently within the same platform.

- Create, edit, and deactivate landlord/owner records
- Capture landlord's PAN and, if applicable, GSTIN
- Flag each landlord as GST-Registered or Non-GST — this determines whether GST is calculated on their invoices
- Maintain landlord contact details and registered business/billing address
- Associate one or more properties with each landlord
- Assign a default invoice template per landlord (optional; can be overridden per property)

5.3 Tenant Management

Each property may have one or more tenants over time (current and historical).

- Create, edit, and deactivate tenant records
- Capture tenant's PAN and, if applicable, GSTIN (required for tenants claiming input tax credit)
- Capture tenant contact details, lease start date, and lease end date
- Link each tenant to a specific property
- Maintain tenant status: Active, Notice Period, or Vacated

5.4 Rental Rate Configuration

Rental rates are defined per property/tenant combination and drive automatic invoice calculation.

- Define monthly rent amount for a property/tenant
- Optionally define additional recurring charges (e.g. maintenance, parking)
- Define GST rate to apply, where the landlord is GST-registered (e.g. 18%)
- Define effective-from and effective-to dates, supporting rent revisions over time without losing historical rate data
- Prevent overlapping active rates for the same tenant/property

5.5 Invoice Generation

Invoices are generated on a monthly basis, using the rate and template configuration active for that billing period.

- Generate invoices for a selected billing month, across one or more properties/landlords
- Automatically calculate rent, additional charges, GST (if applicable), and total payable
- Auto-generate a unique, sequential invoice number per landlord
- Support regenerating/correcting an invoice before it is marked final (with audit trail of changes)
- Mark invoice status as Draft, Generated, or Sent

5.6 Invoice Template Management

Admins can define and maintain one or more invoice templates that control the visual presentation of generated invoices.

- Upload and manage landlord/business logo
- Configure colour scheme (header colour, accent colour)
- Configure business name, address, and footer text (e.g. bank details, terms)
- Maintain multiple templates and assign a default template per landlord or property
- Preview a template before applying it to live invoices

5.7 PDF Generation & Storage

- Generate each invoice as a PDF document using the applicable template
- Store the PDF against the specific tenant, property, and billing period for future retrieval
- Allow download of individual invoice PDFs, and bulk download for a selected period/landlord

5.8 GST Monthly Reporting

For GST-registered landlords, the system consolidates GST collected across all their invoices for a given period.

- Generate a monthly GST summary report per landlord, showing total taxable value and total GST collected
- Break down GST collected (e.g. CGST/SGST or IGST, based on landlord configuration) to support GST return filing
- Exclude Non-GST landlords from GST reporting, since no GST is applicable on their invoices
- Allow report export (PDF/Excel) for use in filing GSTR returns

5.9 User & Role Management

- Admin can create user accounts and assign one of the three roles: Admin, Manager, or Landlord
- Manager accounts can be scoped to specific landlords/properties
- Landlord accounts are automatically scoped to their own data only
- Support password reset and basic account activation/deactivation

6. Data Capture Requirements

The following tables define the key data fields to be captured for each core entity in the system.

6.1 Property

Field	Type	Description
Property ID	System-generated	Unique identifier for the property
Property Name	Text	Display name of the property (e.g. building/unit name)
Address	Text (multi-line)	Full property address including city, state, and PIN code
Property Type	Dropdown	Residential or Commercial
Area (sq. ft.)	Number	Total built-up/carpet area, for reference
Landlord	Reference	Owning landlord, linked from the Landlord master
Status	Dropdown	Active / Inactive

6.2 Landlord / Owner

Field	Type	Description
Landlord ID	System-generated	Unique identifier for the landlord
Name	Text	Individual name or registered business name
PAN	Text (10 char)	Permanent Account Number of the landlord
GST Registered	Yes / No	Determines whether GST is applied on this landlord's invoices
GSTIN	Text (15 char)	Required only if GST Registered = Yes
Contact Details	Text	Phone number and email address
Billing Address	Text (multi-line)	Registered/billing address for invoice headers
Default Invoice Template	Reference	Default template applied to this landlord's invoices
Status	Dropdown	Active / Inactive

6.3 Tenant

Field	Type	Description
Tenant ID	System-generated	Unique identifier for the tenant
Tenant Name	Text	Individual or company name
PAN	Text (10 char)	Permanent Account Number of the tenant

Field	Type	Description
GSTIN	Text (15 char)	Optional; captured for tenants requiring GST-compliant invoices
Property	Reference	Property occupied by the tenant
Contact Details	Text	Phone number and email address
Lease Start Date	Date	Commencement date of tenancy
Lease End Date	Date	Expected/actual end date of tenancy
Security Deposit	Number	Deposit amount held, for reference
Status	Dropdown	Active / Notice Period / Vacated

6.4 Rental Rate

Field	Type	Description
Rate ID	System-generated	Unique identifier for the rate record
Property / Tenant	Reference	Property and tenant this rate applies to
Monthly Rent	Currency	Base monthly rental amount
Additional Charges	Currency	Optional recurring charges (e.g. maintenance, parking)
GST Applicable	Yes / No	Derived from landlord's GST status; can be reviewed at rate level
GST Rate (%)	Number	Applicable GST percentage, where relevant
Effective From	Date	Start date from which this rate applies
Effective To	Date	End date of this rate (blank if currently active)

6.5 Invoice

Field	Type	Description
Invoice ID / Number	System-generated	Unique, sequential invoice number per landlord
Invoice Date	Date	Date the invoice is generated
Billing Period	Month / Year	Rental month the invoice corresponds to
Landlord	Reference	Landlord raising the invoice
Tenant	Reference	Tenant being billed
Property	Reference	Property the invoice relates to
Rent Amount	Currency	Base rent for the billing period
Additional Charges	Currency	Any additional recurring charges included
GST Amount	Currency	Calculated GST, where applicable (else zero)
Total Amount	Currency	Rent + additional charges + GST
Status	Dropdown	Draft / Generated / Sent
Template Used	Reference	Invoice template applied when generating the PDF

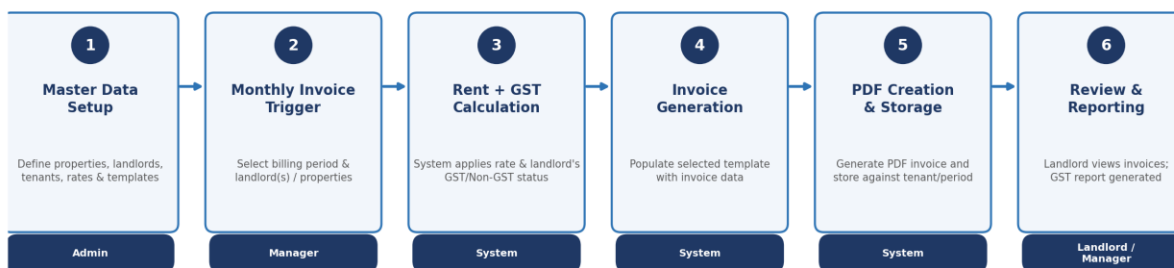
6.6 Invoice Template

Field	Type	Description
Template ID	System-generated	Unique identifier for the template
Template Name	Text	Descriptive name for internal reference
Logo	Image Upload	Business/landlord logo shown on the invoice
Colour Scheme	Colour Picker	Header/accent colours applied to the PDF layout
Business Name	Text	Name displayed on the invoice header
Footer Text	Text (multi-line)	Bank details, terms & conditions, or notes

7. Process Flow — Monthly Invoice Generation

The diagram below illustrates the end-to-end process for generating monthly rental invoices, from master data setup through to landlord-facing reporting.

Rental Invoicing App — Monthly Invoice Generation Process Flow



7.1 Step-by-Step Description

- **Step 1 — Master Data Setup (Admin)** — Admin defines and maintains properties, landlords (with GST status), tenants (with PAN/GST), rental rates, and invoice templates. This is an ongoing activity, updated whenever a new property, tenant, or rate change occurs.
- **Step 2 — Monthly Invoice Trigger (Manager)** — At the start of each billing cycle, the Manager selects the billing period and the landlord(s)/properties to invoice for that month.
- **Step 3 — Rent + GST Calculation (System)** — The system retrieves the active rental rate for each tenant/property and applies GST automatically, based on whether the landlord is flagged as GST-registered.
- **Step 4 — Invoice Generation (System)** — The system populates the applicable invoice template (landlord/property-specific) with the calculated invoice data — tenant details, rent, charges, GST, and total payable.
- **Step 5 — PDF Creation & Storage (System)** — The finalized invoice is rendered as a PDF and stored against the tenant, property, and billing period for future retrieval and audit.
- **Step 6 — Review & Reporting (Landlord / Manager)** — Landlords can log in to view and download their own invoices. Managers can review invoices and the consolidated monthly GST report across the landlords they manage.

8. Reports & Outputs

- **Invoice Register** — A listing of all invoices generated for a selected period, filterable by landlord, property, or status (Draft/Generated/Sent).
- **Monthly GST Report** — For each GST-registered landlord: total taxable value, total GST collected for the period, and a breakdown suitable for GST return filing (e.g. CGST/SGST or IGST, depending on landlord configuration). Non-GST landlords are excluded from this report.
- **Landlord-Wise Summary Report** — A consolidated view (available to Managers and Admins) summarizing total rent invoiced and collected per landlord across all their properties for a given period.
- **Property Occupancy Summary (optional)** — A supporting report showing active vs. vacant properties/tenants, useful for operational tracking alongside invoicing.

9. Non-Functional Requirements

- **Access Control** — Role-based access control strictly enforced so Landlords can never view another landlord's data, and Managers only access landlords/properties assigned to them.
- **Data Accuracy** — Rent and GST calculations must be deterministic and auditable — any manual override to an invoice before finalization should be logged with a reason.
- **Audit Trail** — Maintain a change history for master data (rate changes, landlord GST status changes) and invoice status changes.
- **Data Retention** — Invoices and reports should be retained indefinitely (or per statutory record-keeping requirements) to support future GST audits.
- **Performance** — Monthly invoice generation for a landlord's full property portfolio should complete within a few minutes, even for portfolios with hundreds of tenants.
- **Backup & Recovery** — Regular automated backups of master data, invoices, and generated PDFs.
- **Usability** — The interface should be simple enough for non-technical building owners to use directly, given Landlord is a first-class, self-service role.

10. Assumptions & Constraints

- Rental rates are assumed to be fixed for a given effective period; mid-cycle prorated billing (e.g. partial month) is treated as a configurable option, not a default requirement.
- GST rate and applicability rules follow standard Indian GST regulations as configured by the Admin; the system does not independently validate GST law changes.
- Tenants do not have login access in Phase 1; invoices are shared with tenants outside the system (e.g. email/print) by the Manager or Landlord.
- A single tenant is assumed to occupy one property at a time per active lease; multi-property tenancies can be modeled as separate tenant-property links if needed.

11. Future Enhancements (Post Phase 1)

- Online rent payment collection with payment gateway integration
- Tenant self-service portal for viewing/downloading their own invoices
- Automated payment reminders via email/SMS/WhatsApp
- Integration with accounting platforms (e.g. Tally, Zoho Books, QuickBooks)
- E-invoicing / IRN generation for GST-registered landlords, where applicable
- Automated scheduled invoice generation (e.g. auto-run on the 1st of each month)

12. Glossary

Field	Type	Description
PAN	—	Permanent Account Number — a unique tax identification number issued to individuals/entities in India
GST	—	Goods and Services Tax — indirect tax applicable on the supply of goods/services in India
GSTIN	—	GST Identification Number — a unique registration number for GST-registered entities
CGST / SGST	—	Central/State GST — components of GST applicable on intra-state transactions
IGST	—	Integrated GST — applicable on inter-state transactions
GSTR	—	GST Return — periodic statutory filing summarizing GST collected/paid